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SECURITY



Tea app disables DMs
after second data breach
exposed over a million
private messages

Last week, the dating safety app Tea experienced a [data breach](#), exposing 72,000 sensitive images containing selfies and photo IDs for account verification, as well as images from posts and messages. The personal data was reportedly shared by users on 4chan.

As now reported by [404 Media](#), a second security issue exposed more user data, prompting the app to disable its direct messaging feature on Tuesday afternoon.

Earlier this week, 404 Media received a tip from independent security researcher Kasra Rahjerdi, including messages between users sharing phone numbers and discussing abortions and unfaithful partners.

The app — created to provide a platform for women to exchange information about men they've dated — released a [statement](#) last week regarding the initial breach, stating that it only affected users who signed up before February 2024. Rahjerdi's findings revealed messages from early 2023 until up to last week, with more than 1.1 million messages recorded.

Seemingly in response to the report, Tea [announced](#) on Instagram that it has temporarily disabled its direct messaging feature. The company stated that "Out of an abundance of caution, we have taken the affected system offline,"

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likely as a precaution following the second security incident.

Tea, which launched in 2023 but has since gained wide attention, currently ranks No. 2 on the Apple App Store's top free app chart. According to estimates from Sensor Tower, the app has around 2 million monthly active users as of this month.

This story was updated to include the app's announcement on Instagram and Sensor Tower estimates.

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Lauren Forristal



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IMAGE CREDITS: BUMBLE

APPS



Bumble heightens safety measures with new ID verification feature

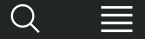
Lauren Forristal — 8:34 AM PDT · March 17, 2025

Bumble is finally catching up with competitor Tinder with a new ID verification feature as dating app users [urge for more safety measures](#).

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The feature is currently available in the U.S., U.K., Australia, Canada, France, India, Ireland, Spain, Germany, Mexico, and New Zealand. It plans to expand to additional markets soon.

Bumble’s ID verification badge comes as AI makes it harder to figure out which [dating profiles](#) are real or fake. It also comes as romance scams continue. Rival [Tinder](#) expanded its identity verification program last year to the U.S., U.K., Brazil, and Mexico.

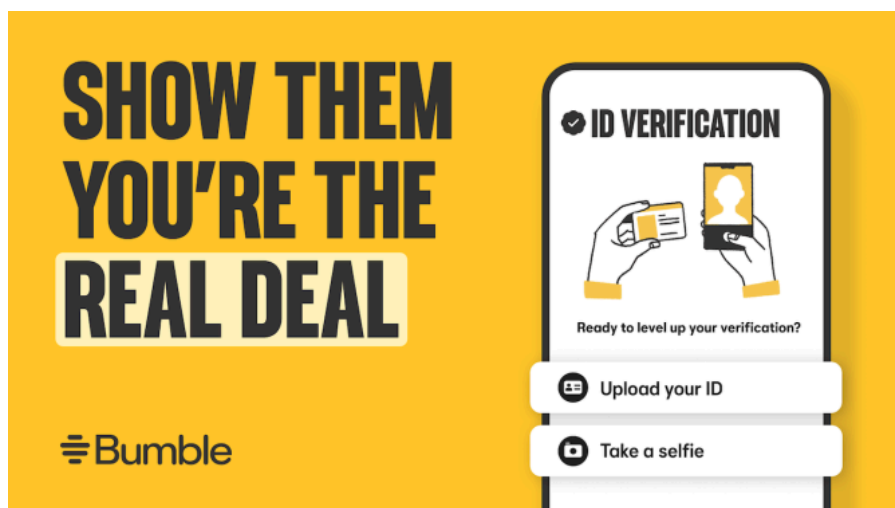


IMAGE CREDITS: BUMBLE

Additionally, a new “Share Date” feature allows Bumble users to share their date details — such as the person they’re meeting, the time, and location — with people they trust. If plans change, they can

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update their friends directly in the app. Tinder [launched](#) a “Share My Date” feature in April 2024.

Another feature focused on safety, “Review Before You Send,” targets the messaging section, where users frequently encounter inappropriate messages. Initially introduced for the Compliments feature, Review Before You Send reminds senders to edit flagged messages before sending.

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Bumble’s new “Discover” experience offers a new way to find the most compatible people. Similar to [Tinder’s “Explore” page](#), users can explore different categories to find people with shared dating intentions, similar interests, and communities. The profiles are refreshed daily.

The feature announcements are part of Bumble’s attempt to restore growth to its dating app, following a [3.8% decline](#) in quarterly app revenue to \$212.4 million in the fourth quarter.

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Bumble to leverage AI to help users with profile creation and conversations

Lauren Forristal — 2:00 PM PDT · September 10, 2024

Bumble is increasing its investments in AI and branching out with new features to stay relevant amid a generational shift in dating behavior among younger users. During Goldman Sachs' annual [technology conference](#) on Monday, Bumble CEO Lidiane Jones unveiled more details about the app's upcoming AI capabilities, including a photo selection tool as well as features to help with conversations and profile creation.

Jones previously teased the features in Bumble's latest [earnings presentation](#).

During a call with investors, she said, "We will also introduce new AI-driven features, including an AI-assisted photo picker to ease the profile creation process and conversation support that will help our customers gain confidence to be their best selves. We have an ambitious view of how AI will enhance the value we deliver to our customers in each step of the dating journey for profile creation, discovery, engagement, and the core of our matching models."

The new AI-powered features are launching on the app this winter.

Bumble's photo picker tool will put it in closer competition with Tinder, [which released its AI "Photo Selector" feature](#) this summer, providing users with suggested selfies taken from their camera roll. Tinder currently touts 9.6 million paying users, whereas Bumble has 2.8 million users as of Q2 2024.

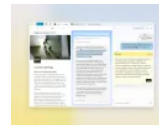
Based on yesterday's comments made by Jones, the company suggests it's also working on additional tools to help with profile creation, but didn't go into specific detail.

"We want the bar for profile creation to continue to be high, but we want to reduce the friction that

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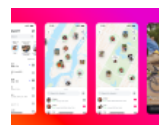
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exists for users. Users have a lot of anxiety in creating profiles. We're going to make that as smooth as possible. So profile creation is a big one," Jones noted during the conference.



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There's more than just uploading photos that go into making a profile; users must also come up with a compelling bio and prompts to attract potential matches. How Bumble plans to power this experience with AI for now remains unclear. Bumble didn't respond to our request for comment.

If Bumble were to launch additional AI profile creation features, the company may copy a feature from Tinder's future product roadmap. Tinder CPO Mark Van Ryswyk once [mentioned](#) the idea of using generative AI to write bios for dating profiles.



BUMBLE FOR FRIENDS HAS AN AI-GENERATED ICEBREAKER FEATURE THAT HELPS USERS WRITE MESSAGES.

IMAGE CREDITS: BUMBLE

Additionally, using AI to encourage singles to be more creative with their opening lines feels like a no-brainer for Bumble. Last year, the company released an [AI-generated icebreaker feature](#) for Bumble for Friends, its friendship-focused product, so it would make sense if the dating app rolled out a similar feature. With the icebreaker feature, users can generate messages based on the other person's profile.

Jones said, “[Another] big factor is customers are much happier and successful, and they engage in healthy conversations with each other. So, we want to provide more support for people to enter healthy conversations.”

In addition to the newly announced AI features, we may expect Bumble to expand its AI approach further in the future. Bumble founder Whitney Wolfe Herd [previously shared](#) that her idea of online dating could see AI “dating concierges” or assistants going on numerous dates on a user's behalf.

Meanwhile, Bumble has been using AI to power its safety features for a few years now. For instance, its “Deception Detector” tool detects and removes

fake profiles, spammers, and scammers, and its “[Private Detector](#)” feature automatically blurs nude photos. More recently, the company [introduced](#) a new option that lets members report profiles if they believe the photos and videos are generated with the use of AI.

Jones reiterated at the conference that Bumble is holding off on launching any new paid features as it continues to improve the free experience. This includes expanding “[Opening Moves](#),” adding more interest filters and customizations for its chat timer (which currently only gives users 24 hours to send a message), as well as making improvements to its matching algorithm.

The company also has plans for the recently acquired community platform [Geneva](#), which is gearing up for a relaunch in late fall.

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